DISCOURSE ANALYSIS ON FILIPINO LGBTQ PODCAST STORIES: EXPLORING STORYTELLING AS EXPRESSIONS OF EMPATHY AND EMPOWERMENT

CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

The LGBTQ community has faced unfair treatment for a long time. Many still experience discrimination, few opportunities, and social exclusion. Espiritu et al. (2022) said that coming out often elicits bad reactions. McGuire et al. (2022) added that even small acts of hate can cause sadness and low self-esteem. The continued marginalization of LGBTQ individuals may have an effect on their general well-being.

The LGBTQ community now uses social media to connect and find support. According to Berger et. al. (2022), people can express themselves more freely in online spaces. Online experience sharing reduces loneliness according to Eickers (2024). These platforms also allow people to promote equality and fight discrimination (Hu, 2022).

Podcasts empower the voice of the LGBTQ people. For intance, take the case of scholarship from Tufan and Senyuz, Copeland, and Magnus. Tufan and Şenyüz (2023) said podcasts help with representation and belonging. Meanwhile, Copeland (2022) explained that sound media let people speak when ignored by others. Lastly, Mangus (2023) added that podcast shows queer stories as normal and accepted.

Likewise, podcasts are found on many platforms and help people feel connected (Donison, 2023). Filipino LGBTQ creators talk about real problems (i.e. lgbtq experinces) (Tan, 2022). Bond and Miller (2024) said YouTube and TikTok help boost confidence and friendships. These spaces teach people to understand and care for each other (Shinbine et al., 2025).

Moreover, podcasts let listeners and creators connect in a personal way. Wendland (2024) said they help create open and welcoming communities. Penfold et al. (2024) added that podcasts let people explore and express who they are. Ulla et al. (2024) said LGBTQ language in podcasts builds strength and unity.

This study explores how Filipino LGBTQ podcasts use language to express stories and emotions. De Backer and Slembrouck (2024) found that podcast stories show creativity and experiences. Podcasts are more than entertainment; they give space for identity and strength. However, few studies have focused on Filipino queer podcasts, showing the need for deeper study.

This study is significant because it highlights how Filipino LGBTQ podcasts promote empathy and empowerment through storytelling. By analyzing podcast discourse, it deepens the understanding of how language becomes a tool for empowerment and identity expression. The findings will benefit scholars in communication and linguistics, educators advocating inclusivity, and LGBTQ creators who use digital media to inspire empathy, equality, and social awareness.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

This section reviews studies on podcasting as a platform for advocacy and narrative expression, emphasizing how storytelling fosters empathy, emotional connection, and empowerment in queer communities. It highlights critical discourse analysis in examining language, representation, and identity, along with literature on Filipino LGBTQ experiences in media. Overall, these works show how Filipino LGBTQ podcasts amplify voices, build belonging, and promote empowerment.

Linguistic and Thematic Features of LGBTQ Narratives

Language and storytelling shape how LGBTQ individuals express identity, emotion, and belonging. Through discourse, queer narratives transform personal experiences into acts of empowerment and community-building.

De Backer and Slembrouck (2024) revealed that podcast storytelling, such as in *Coming Out Stories*, uses linguistic cues like repetition and tone to convey transformation and empathy. Similarly, Tufan and Şenyüz (2023) found that queer podcasts in Türkiye serve as counterpublic spaces where recurring phrases such as “visibility” and “solidarity” reinforce empowerment and resistance. Together, these studies highlight how digital narratives function as safe spaces for self-expression and advocacy.

In another linguistic perspective, Ulla, Macaraeg, and Ferrera (2024) examined Filipino queer language and discovered word-formation strategies like affixation (“charot,” “gorabels”) and stylized reversals (“hanabishi”) that signify identity, humor, and cultural creativity. Likewise, Crowley (2025) showed that queer and trans language carries racialized ideologies, where terms like “sis” and “queen” symbolize inclusion, while “micro-labels” reflect linguistic gatekeeping. These findings affirm that queer language evolves as both innovation and resistance.

Leung (2021) explored intersectional “coming out” experiences, revealing how phrases like “minority within a minority” express ongoing negotiation between ethnicity and sexuality. Complementing this, Barsigian et al. (2020) found that genderqueer individuals use language to challenge stigma and reimagine belonging through expressions of unintelligibility

and resistance. Thus, linguistic expression becomes a means of self-definition against social norms.

Finally, Beisembayeva and Issina (2022) demonstrated how shifting gender language blurs binary boundaries—where traits like “career” and “appearance” defy traditional roles—showing that linguistic flexibility mirrors social transformation. Carr (2021) likewise emphasized that affirming language, such as “safe space” and “ally in action,” creates inclusion in education. Both underscore how word choice directly affects empowerment and acceptance.

Ultimately, these studies reveal that LGBTQ narratives are grounded in linguistic creativity, emotional honesty, and social critique—turning language into a transformative tool for identity, empathy, and equality.

Storytelling as a Tool for Empathy and Emotional Connection

Storytelling functions as an emotional bridge that connects people through shared experiences. It helps listeners enter another’s perspective, cultivating understanding and compassion. In the realm of Filipino LGBTQ podcasts, storytelling embodies emotional openness and solidarity, making it a vital discourse of empathy and empowerment.

McPhail (2022) found that reading LGBTQ+ narratives fosters empathy even among non-LGBTQ+ individuals through *narrative transportation*, where readers emotionally immerse themselves in others’ lives. Similarly, Burgess, Rogers, and Jefferies (2023) revealed that storytelling and empathy work together to humanize social interactions and strengthen moral understanding. Both studies affirm that emotional narratives transcend identity

boundaries, fostering shared compassion and awareness. Hence, storytelling transforms emotion into understanding.

Moreover, storytelling in digital media deepens emotional resonance through authentic voices and self-expression. Ferrari et al. (2022) emphasized that digital storytelling evokes stronger empathy and compassion because of its raw honesty and vulnerability. In the same way, Ying et al. (2024) discovered that podcast listeners develop empathic awareness by reflecting on emotional stories and applying compassionate communication. These findings highlight that digital narratives create spaces where empathy grows naturally through connection. Thus, online storytelling nurtures reflection and emotional engagement.

In addition, narrative sharing serves as an empowering act for marginalized voices. Sørine (2022) explained that women podcasters use personal storytelling to challenge gender norms and build listener communities that offer emotional validation. Correspondingly, Tufan and Şenyüz (2023) showed that queer podcasts in Türkiye function as alternative spaces of resistance, promoting visibility and solidarity through authentic conversations.

Furthermore, storytelling also affirms cultural identity and collective healing. Macapugay and Nakamura (2024) proposed the SENSEI framework, which integrates storytelling, engagement, and identity to empower marginalized learners and communities. Alongside Ferrari et al. (2022) and Ying et al. (2024), they highlighted how shared narratives foster mutual care, empathy, and self-understanding. These perspectives demonstrate that storytelling reclaims agency while inspiring emotional connection. Therefore, stories become instruments of both empathy and empowerment.

In summary, storytelling bridges emotion, culture, and identity, transforming individual narratives into collective empathy. Within Filipino LGBTQ podcasts, these

narratives serve as heartfelt spaces of compassion, representation, and solidarity—proving that storytelling itself is a discourse of emotional empowerment.

Empowerment and Resistance through Queer Discourse

Queer discourse powerfully transforms silence into visibility. Roman-Tamesis (2023) revealed that Filipino beauty pageants act as transformative arenas where queer individuals "amplify marginalized voices" and "defy societal norms," constructing identity through performance and pride. In a related manner, Gamboa, Ilac, Carangan, and Agida (2020) portrayed queer leaders who resist heteronormativity by reimagining leadership as "a desire for intimacy," queering public service into a space of compassion and equality. Together, these studies depict empowerment as an embodied act that dismantles exclusion.

Meanwhile, Aguilar and Dela Peña (2024) highlighted lesbian empowerment in *Baka Bukas* and *Si Chedeng at Si Apple*, where queer women practice "subtle resistance" through humor, intimacy, and self-discovery. Similarly, Tan (2022) explored how Filipino queer individuals construct "counter-sites to heteronormativity" across online and offline spaces, transforming virtual and physical environments into stages of liberation. Both show that storytelling and spatial expression resist repression by validating identity.

Furthermore, Lo (2022) examined Chinese lesbians' "conflicted pragmatism" in negotiating family expectations within online queer counterpublics, illustrating resistance within constraint. Correspondingly, Gore (2021) theorized that queer oppression and activism are inseparable from global capitalism, where sexuality serves as "a constitutive element of political economy." These studies expand queer discourse beyond identity politics, situating empowerment amid digital, familial, and economic power structures.

In addition, Copeland (2023) celebrated queer joy as a radical act in the *Homoground* podcast, which sustains "queer world-making" through sonic storytelling and collective creativity. The podcast's "multimodal space of queer collectivity" transforms joy into a form of affective resistance that resists digital exclusion. Similarly, Roman-Tamesis (2023) described pageantry as a performative site of pride that reshapes belonging. Consequently, both works show that joy and pride are political forms of survival

Across these diverse perspectives, queer discourse reveals empowerment as both rebellion and renewal. By resisting silence through story, leadership, theory, and sound, queer voices continuously reconstruct spaces of freedom, turning marginalization into agency and identity into revolution.

Digital Spaces and Online Belonging

Digital platforms have become transformative spaces for LGBTQ people to express and negotiate identity. Criss (2025) revealed that digital engagement involves *"identity negotiation"* shaped by audience perception, anonymity, and social identity, showing how online interaction is both liberating and performative. Likewise, DeVine et al. (2025) demonstrated that mixed-media tools like *Identity Boards* allow users to *"visually express their experiences"* and resist rigid identity definitions. In sum, digital environments offer fluid avenues for self-presentation and dialogue.

Online communities function as safe and educational havens for diverse gender identities. Cronesberry (2024) found that *"safe spaces in virtual places"* promote validation and awareness for gender-diverse youth through exposure to less visible identities. Similarly, Lopez-Leon and Casanova (2025) emphasized that *digital counterspaces* enable Latinx LGBTQ+ emerging adults to resist marginalization and construct coherent intersectional

selves. Altogether, these findings confirm that supportive online networks nurture empowerment and self-acceptance.

Social media also strengthens belonging through connection and representation. Eickers (2024) explained that interaction with others in digital spaces allows LGBTQ+ individuals to *"escape aloneness"* and *"find community"*, linking visibility to feelings of togetherness. Complementing this, Kurup (2024) observed that while online social support improves *daily affect*, it may not fully buffer long-term well-being against marginalization stress. Thus, digital belonging provides immediate comfort but limited durability.

However, not all digital spaces are harmonious. Trafford et al. (2024) uncovered *"internal conflict"* within online LGBTQIA+ communities, where gatekeeping and erasure fracture unity. Their focus groups reveal how peer-driven tensions affect visibility and inclusion. Consequently, online queer spaces embody both solidarity and struggle, reminding us that belonging can coexist with exclusion.

In conclusion, these studies collectively illustrate how digital platforms serve as mirrors of queer identity—simultaneously empowering and contested. They highlight that through storytelling, design innovation, and supportive networks, LGBTQ individuals transform online environments into dynamic arenas for identity, connection, and resilience.

Representation and Visibility in Media

Representation and visibility in media have evolved as vital tools for shaping public understanding and identity formation among marginalized groups. Gao and Guintu (2025) explained that portrayals of LGBTQ+ people in film and television have shifted from exclusion to inclusive narratives that "influence the attitude of the audience" and "minimize societal prejudice." Similarly, Monaghan (2024) found that streaming platforms' classification systems

affect the visibility and cultural definition of queer media through algorithmic labeling such as “Pride” or “good character.” Together, these studies underscore that media visibility carries both representational power and commercial constraints.

Visibility is also strongly mediated by digital affordances and social media participation. Are, Talbot, and Briggs (2024) discovered that social media provides “inspiring, entertaining, and reassuring” visibility for queer users but that self-presentation varies with age and life stage. Likewise, Safari, Andrade, and Techatassanasoontorn (2022) introduced an instrument for measuring knowledge visibility, showing how visibility metrics can systematize online community interaction. Both studies affirm that visibility online is not simply exposure but a negotiated practice of agency and safety within digital infrastructures.

Moreover, representation connects deeply to identity work among LGBTQ+ individuals. Bates, Hobman, and Bell (2020) described how LGBTQ+ youth construct narrative identities in social media spaces through “merging safe spaces” and “external identity alignment,” highlighting how online visibility enables self-authorship. Complementing this, Tan (2022) analyzed queer Filipinos’ online and offline experiences, revealing that “queer spaces are imminently formed in resistance to heteronormativity” and that visibility becomes an act of empowerment. These studies collectively demonstrate that digital and physical platforms function as arenas where representation cultivates belonging and resilience.

Consequently, visibility and representation remain uneven and context-bound. Gao and Guintu (2025) noted persistent tokenism and “queerbaiting,” while Are et al. (2024) emphasized that visibility alone does not ensure empowerment without supportive affordances. Tan (2022) further stressed that Filipino queer narratives reveal both liberation and constraint within cultural norms. Thus, visibility is dynamic—simultaneously affirming identity and negotiating systemic limits.

To conclude, these researches illustrates that media visibility—across films, streaming services, and social platforms—enables empathy, identity negotiation, and empowerment, yet it demands critical awareness of how algorithms, cultures, and audiences shape whose stories truly become seen.

Queer Theory and Performativity in Digital Storytelling

Queer theory offers a framework for understanding how digital narratives challenge traditional power and identity structures. Mangnus (2023) used queer theory to reveal how online storytelling destabilizes heteronormativity by emphasizing the importance of voice, invisibility, and inclusivity in digital spaces. Similarly, Ferreyra (2022) grounded her analysis in queer theoretical principles by showing how podcasts disrupt conventional gender and sexuality portrayals through narrative diversity and resistance to fixed identities. Thus, queer theory becomes a means of interpreting digital storytelling as a space of transformation and resistance.

Tan (2022) applied queer theory to explore how gender and identity are continually produced and negotiated between online and offline spaces. His interpretive phenomenological study exposed how queer Filipinos resist heteronormative social control by performing and reimagining gender through virtual and physical expressions. Likewise, Haber (2019) employed queer theory to critique digital temporality, arguing that the fleeting nature of online interactions redefines intimacy, risk, and privacy for queer users. Therefore, these studies illustrate how queer theory contextualizes digital performativity as an act of reconfiguration against normative boundaries.

Queer theory also provides a foundation for understanding storytelling as performative identity construction. Thomas (2021) incorporated Butler’s and Warner’s ideas

of performativity and queer worldmaking to explain how podcasts become political acts of self-expression and communal belonging. Meanwhile, Sarce (2023) extended queer theory into a Filipino context, transforming it through a decolonial lens that reinterprets “awra” as a performative assertion of queer tropical identity. Hence, queer theory is not static but adaptable, illuminating how performance, language, and culture converge in digital storytelling.

Finally, Reyes et al. (2024) integrated queer theoretical perspectives on affirmation and resilience by linking digital inclusivity to improved mental health outcomes among LGBTQ+ youth. Their study reflected that representation and supportive discourse serve as protective mechanisms against marginalization. Collectively, these works demonstrate that queer theory guides the interpretation of digital storytelling as both a performative and liberating practice that validates queer existence and fosters solidarity.

Community Support and Collective Identity

Community support and collective identity play a central role in shaping the lived experiences of LGBTQ individuals. Nieva-Lustanas (2025) used a qualitative phenomenological design to explore how LGBTQIA+ school heads experience leadership in Quezon Province. Through semi-structured interviews and thematic analysis, the study revealed “genderless leadership” and “community acceptance” as key themes that promote inclusivity and identity reaffirmation. Similarly, Marasigan (2025) applied transcendental phenomenology to understand LGBTQIA+ students’ coping mechanisms against restrictive school policies, highlighting that peer validation and supportive teachers build resilience. Together, these studies demonstrate that leadership and educational spaces thrive when inclusive environments strengthen collective identity and belonging.

In another perspective, Domingo and Escobido (2024) and Presto (2020) utilized qualitative methods to uncover how Filipino LGBTQ+ individuals negotiate their identities through family and community. Domingo and Escobido (2024) found that family acceptance serves as empowerment during the coming-out process, while rejection rooted in religion leads to concealment and stigma. Meanwhile, Presto (2020) examined rural bakla youth through intersectionality, revealing conditional acceptance tied to gender performance and economic contribution. Both studies affirm that familial and social support foster collective resilience even amid structural inequalities.

Likewise, Libiran et al. (2024) and Galanza et al. (2024) applied phenomenological approaches to examine institutional experiences of Filipino LGBTQ+ individuals. Libiran et al. (2024) explored religious contexts and revealed faith as both a "source of resilience and harm," exposing the duality of religion in LGBTQ+ lives. Similarly, Galanza et al. (2024) focused on LGBT nurses and found that despite workplace stereotyping and microaggressions, participants displayed authenticity and sought acceptance within hospital communities. These findings illustrate that faith and workplace interactions shape collective identity and community belonging through shared struggles.

Moreover, Killip (2025) and Villasanta et al. (2025) addressed the importance of support systems for marginalized groups within indigenous and youth communities. Killip (2025) employed descriptive exploratory design to study LGBTQ+ elders, showing that while traditional beliefs hinder inclusion, informal networks serve as emotional anchors. Villasanta et al. (2025) used a developmental design to create self-help materials for LGBTQ+ youth, which were positively rated for improving self-compassion and identity awareness. Collectively, these studies affirm that support—whether emotional, institutional, or digital—nurtures empowerment and strengthens collective identity among Filipino LGBTQ communities.

Critical Discourse Analysis as a Framework

Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) provides a powerful framework for examining how language constructs gender, sexuality, and power across institutional and digital spaces. Drawing on Fairclough's (1992, 1995) model, scholars emphasize that discourse not only reflects but actively shapes social realities, making it a key lens for exploring queer representation and identity formation in modern contexts.

Fan (2019) showed that Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) reveals bias in news through language features like tone and word choice. Rodrigues et al. (2025) used CDA in the Philippines and found that language in student writings includes and excludes LGBTQ identities. This study shows that CDA reveals how words reflect social control and beliefs.

Huang and Pu (2024) combined CDA with critical realism to better explain social causes behind language use. Nguyen et al. (2025) used CDA on Vietnamese news and found changing views of LGBT people based on stigma to acceptance. These show that CDA can connect language to social change, especially in online media like podcasts. Likewise, CDA reveals the double-edged nature of digital queer visibility. Huang, et. Al., (2025) argued that online platforms simultaneously empower and regulate queer voices, as sociocultural norms and algorithms govern visibility. Their findings affirm that digital discourse is a space of both recognition and risk within contemporary identity politics.

Kulkov et al. (2024) gave a guide for using CDA in podcast research, focusing on ethics and meaning in sound and speech. Donison (2023) and Tufan (2023) found that LGBTQ podcasts give spaces for expression and challenge norms. Conte et al. (2024) showed that CDA helps explain how online media like YouTube and podcasts reshape identity and history.

Similarly, CDA reveals the double-edged nature of digital queer visibility. Huang, Zeng, Tanaka, and Shahin (2025) argued that online platforms simultaneously empower and

regulate queer voices, as sociocultural norms and algorithms govern visibility. Their findings affirm that digital discourse is a space of both recognition and risk within contemporary identity politics.

Additionally, Rodriguez, Beronilla, Colita, and Tulud (2025) found that while student publications advocate inclusion, linguistic structures often reinforce heteronormative hierarchies (Fairclough, 1992; Wodak & Meyer, 2016). Similarly, Montecillo, Bonaoy, and Aperocho (2025) revealed through gendered discourse analysis that narratives by trans and biological women express differing degrees of resistance and inclusion, showing how gender politics are negotiated linguistically.

Digital platforms and media serve as new arenas where discourse constructs collective identity and activism. Moldovan et al. (2025) showed that podcast language mobilizes solidarity and emotional engagement, while Teleki, Dong, Liu, and Caverlee (2025) uncovered masculine biases in digital discourse and algorithmic models. Gupta et al. (2025) further demonstrated that podcast narratives subtly shape public perceptions through framing strategies, revealing CDA's relevance in analyzing sociotechnical systems and gendered media bias.

Overall, these studies affirm CDA's indispensability in analyzing the linguistic and ideological construction of queer identity. Through education, media, and digital spaces, CDA uncovers how discourse both sustains and resists systems of power—illustrating that the struggle for queer representation is deeply rooted in the politics of language itself.

Filipino Queer Narrative and Local Contexts

Studies show that Filipino queerness is dynamic and context-driven, reflecting ongoing negotiations of visibility and belonging within social, linguistic, and cultural spaces

(Ulla, Macaraeg, & Ferrera, 2024; Aguilar & Dela Peña, 2023). Tan (2022) explored how Filipino LGBTQ people express pride and identity through local and global spaces. Espiritu et al. (2022) found that family support helps in the coming-out process. Rodrigues et al. (2025) showed that campus writings balance tradition and advocacy inclusion. Medina (2023) explained that humour and terms like "beki" and "bading" empower LGBTQ identity.

Language serves as a powerful tool for self-expression and inclusion in queer communities. Ulla et al. (2024) found that Filipino queer language, or *beki speak*, fosters identity and empowerment through linguistic creativity such as neologisms and recontextualization. Similarly, Javellana and Eustaquio (2024) revealed that expressions like *Sana all* promote inclusivity among Generation Z, illustrating how language shapes empathy and collective belonging.

On the other hand, Media and literature provide vital spaces for representing Filipino queer identities. Aguilar and Dela Peña (2023) showed that films like *Baka Bukas* and *Si Chedeng at Si Apple* highlight lesbian visibility while reflecting social constraints, whereas Rellin (2024) emphasized how Philippine literature reclaims queer voices against colonial and religious ideologies (Collantes, 2018). These portrayals reveal resistance and adaptation within Filipino culture.

Tan (2022) stated that online spaces are safer for Filipino self-expression. Espiritu et al. (2022) found that visibility online builds confidence. Rodrigues et al. (2025) noted that inclusion depends on social class. Leandro et al. (2025) said that Filipino digital stories use empathy to promote inclusivity.

Yuan and Guintu (2025) said that Asian media studies show how language helps promote gender equality and understanding. Filipino LGBTQ storytelling in digital spaces connects emotions, humour, and identity. These stories create empathy, pride, and a sense of belonging , helping the LGBTQ community gain strength and visibility.

In brief, Filipino LGBTQ narratives use creative language and digital storytelling to build solidarity and identity. Podcasts work as a social tool where queer Filipinos express belonging, resistance, bias, and support one another in both online and local places.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

This study is grounded in Judith Butler's Queer Theory, focusing on gender performativity and resistance to heteronormativity, supported by Fairclough's Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA). Butler (1990) explains that gender is not fixed but performed through repeated actions, language, and social behavior. In this view, identity and sexuality are fluid constructions shaped by culture and discourse.

Concerning performativity, Butler explains that heteronormativity operates by naturalizing the binary view of gender and compulsory heterosexuality, making these identities appear fixed and biologically determined rather than socially produced through repeated actions (Butler, 1990; Salih, 2002). Through this lens, gender becomes a regulatory ideaenforced by societal expectations that individuals must consistently perform behaviors aligned with "male" or "female" norms to be recognized as legitimate (Butler, 1988). These continuous and normalized performances maintain heteronormativity by reinforcing what is considered "normal" and marginalizing identities that fall outside these standards (SozTheo, 2023).

However, Butler also emphasizes that because these norms rely on repetition, they are never fully stable — meaning gender performances can deviate, fail, or be intentionally subverted (Butler, 1990; Morgenroth & Ryan, 2019). Acts such as drag, gender non-conformity, and alternative queer expressions expose how gender is constructed, thereby revealing cracks within heteronormative systems and challenging the notion of a

single “valid” identity. Through these resistant performances, individuals disrupt normative power structures, empowering fluid and diverse expressions of sexuality and identity that defy cultural expectations (Oikonomakis, 2024).

Using these lens, Queer Theory explains how podcast hosts and guests perform their identities and how these performances challenge heteronormative structures that often silence or marginalize queer voices. As Butler (1993) further emphasized in *Bodies That Matter*, language has the power to both constrain and liberate—through speaking and storytelling, individuals reclaim agency and visibility. Hence, this study views podcast storytelling as a form of resistance, where queer Filipinos construct alternative narratives that reject traditional binaries of male/female and heterosexual/homosexual. Their stories transform personal experiences into acts of empowerment and empathy, reshaping how society perceives gender and sexuality.

Many scholars have expanded Queer Theory in digital spaces. Ruberg and Ruelos (2020) introduced "queer data" to promote more inclusive online representation. Tufan and Şenyüz (2023) described LGBTQ podcasts as a safe space that challenges silence and oppression. Fauzi Fitri Andika et al. (2024) showed how online self-representation builds advocacy and inclusion. Consequently, this theory guides the study in understanding how language, media, and identity connect in Filipino LGBTQ storytelling. It highlights that LGBTQ podcasting is a form of activism. Storytelling becomes a way to challenge stereotypes and promote acceptance in society.

Complementing this theoretical lens, Fairclough’s Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) serves as the study’s analytical foundation. Critical Discourse Analysis examines how language reflects power and social relations, helping reveal how podcast discourse expresses inclusion, empathy, and solidarity. Through this combined framework, the study views

Filipino LGBTQ podcast storytelling not just as communication but as a performative act of identity and empowerment, where language is used to resist marginalization and build community.

By combining Queer Theory and CDA, this study treats podcast storytelling as both expression and resistance. Queer Theory highlights identity and empowerment, while CDA explains how language creates meaning and challenges power. Thus, in this study, Filipino LGBTQ podcast storytelling serves as a space of performance and self-expression, where individuals use language, humor, and emotion to define their identities and challenge societal norms.

1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study

The general objective of the study is to explore how language is used in podcasts to create spaces of empathy, resistance, and empowerment for marginalized communities.

Likewise, seen below are the research objectives:

1. To identify the recurring linguistic and thematic features that characterize Filipino LGBTQpodcast narratives.

2. To examine how podcast creators use discourse strategies (e.g., tone, humor, storytelling) to express empathy, resilience, and solidarity.

3. To explore how these podcasts linguistically represent experiences of discrimination, acceptance, and empowerment.

4. To analyze how the language of podcast hosts and guests challenges or reinforces social ideologies surrounding LGBTQ identities.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

This chapter explains the methods used in the study, including the research design, data collection procedures, research environment, data sources, analytical tools, and ethical considerations. The study uses a qualitative approach grounded in Norman Fairclough's (1995) Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) and Judith Butler's (1990) Queer Theory, particularly her concept of heteronormativity, to examine how Filipino LGBTQ podcast discourse constructs meanings of identity, support, resilience, and community. Through this framework, the study explores how language in digital queer spaces communicates emotional and social solidarity while negotiating gender norms and power relations.

2.1 Research Design

This study employs a qualitative research design that integrates Fairclough's (1995) CDA with Butler's Queer Theory to analyze how heteronormativity is constructed, reproduced, or contested in Filipino LGBTQ podcast discourse. Fairclough's three-dimensional model guides the analysis. The current approach follow recent scholarships such as those conducted by Fan (2019), Rodrigues et. Al (2025), and Tufan (2023) in which they used CDA to analyze discourse surrounding marginalized communities. Hence, the current study shall also be exploring:

1. Textual Analysis – examining linguistic features such as vocabulary, modality, metaphors, and evaluative language

2. Discursive Practice – analyzing how meanings are produced and interpreted through interaction, turn-taking, and narrative strategies
3. Sociocultural Practice – connecting discourse to broader social norms, particularly heteronormativity, gender expectations, and LGBTQ lived experiences.

Butler's insights on heteronormativity and gender performativity serve as the theoretical lens for understanding how discourse shapes and maintains norms around gender and sexuality, and how queer speakers challenge or renegotiate these norms.

2.2.1 Research Materials and Methods

For the study's research materials, the study will select and analyze five (5) Filipino LGBTQ podcasts that are publiclyavailable on Spotify: Rainbow Talks, The Balut Kiki Project, Liztibo Podcast, Bekenemen Queertuhan with Roanne and Tina. These podcasts were selected because they present diverse Filipino LGBTQ experiences and highlight themes of support, resilience, identity, and solidarity.

To systematize discourse analysis, the study uses ATLAS.ti, or MAXQDA, as the primary qualitative data analysis software. These tools shall be utilized for transcription management, coding management, thematic clustering and generation, memo writing. These features ensure a rigorous, transparent, and theory-aligned analytical process consistent with CDA and Queer TheoryLastly, episodes from each channel will be selected using the inclusion criteria:

1. Content and Focus. Episodes must feature Filipino LGBTQ hosts or guests sharing real-life experiences about identity, resilience, community support, or solidarity (Tufan & Senyuz, 2023; De Backer & Slembrouck, 2024).
2. Duration. Episodes must run 35 minutes to 1 hour, allowing rich conversation and depth of analysis (Kulkov et al., 2024; Fan, 2019).

3. Publicly Available. All selected episodes must be publicly available on Spotify even non-premium accounts, ensuring ethical transparency and accessibility (Kulkov et al., 2024; Fan, 2019).

2.3 Research Environment, Population, and Sample

The research environment consists of digital audio platforms, specifically Spotify, where Filipino LGBTQ podcasts are publicly accessible. The population of interest includes Filipino LGBTQ content creators who produce podcasts centered on identity, community experiences, and empowerment.

Using purposive sampling, five well-known Filipino LGBTQ podcast channels were chosen due totheir thematic alignment with LGBTQ support and solidaritytheir strong audience reachtheir relevance in contemporary queer discourseThese podcasts provide a rich, authentic environment for analyzing naturally occurring conversations within the Filipino queer community.

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

The primary data consists of transcriptions of selected podcast episodes. These transcriptions were analyzed using Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA), following Fan (2019) and Huang & Pu (2024), who affirm CDA's usefulness in uncovering how language reflects ideologies and power structures.

The study adopts Norman Fairclough's three-dimensional CDA framework as the analytical basis, a method endorsed utilized by Fan (2019) and Huang & Pu (2024) for examining the interplay between language and social structures. Fairclough's model conceptualizes discourse as a social practice operating across three interrelated levels:

1. Textual Analysis

- Examines vocabulary, tone, pronoun use, conversational markers, and narrative structure
- Identifies how identity, emotion, and community values are expressed

2. Discursive Practice
    - Analyzes host–guest interactions, turn-taking, storytelling patterns, and shared interpretations
    - Observes how meanings are co-constructed during conversations
3. Social Practice
    - Connects podcast narratives to broader social issues such as heteronormativity, inclusion, discrimination, resilience, and LGBTQ activism
    - Uses Butler's Queer Theory to interpret how speakers affirm, negotiate, or challenge gender and sexuality norms

This multi-level process reveals how podcasts reflect, reinforce, or transform understandings of identity, solidarity, empowerment, and lived realities within the Filipino LGBTQ community.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

Ethical standards shall be complied religiously in this study. Hence, the following measures ensure the protection of intellectual property, the responsible handling of publicly available digital content, and the ethical use of specified research analysis tools. These standards safeguard the rights of the sample, the researchers, and uphold academic integrity, and maintain the credibility of the research process.

2.5.1 Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

The study does not produce new technologies or products requiring patent or trademark protection. It uses publicly available podcast episodes that are properly cited and credited according to academic and fair use guidelines. All materials comply with intellectual property laws and ethical discourse research practices. Additionally, under Republic Act No. 8293 the Intellectual Property Code of the Philippines) the use of copyrighted works for purposes such as research, scholarship, and teaching does not constitute infringement under the “fair use” provision (Section 185.1). These materials are used strictly for educational and research purposes only, ensuring they are not misinterpreted, reproduced for commercial gain, or used to generate funds.

2.5.2 Informed Consent

Since the podcast episodes are publicly accessible on Spotify (even for non-premium accounts), formal informed consent from creators is not required. This is consistent with ethical guidelines for studies using publicly available media, and it aligns with the Philippine Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173), stating thatthe use of copyrighted works for purposes such as research, scholarship, and teaching does not constitute infringement under the “fair use” provision (Section 185.1), which allows the use of publicly shared information for legitimate purposes provided that processing does not violate the rights and privacy of individuals. In adherence to this policy, the study ensures ethical use of the material by representing content accurately, respecting the creators’ intent, and avoiding any alteration or misinterpretation of their narratives.

2.5.3 Data Privacy and Confidentiality

Although the podcast creators' identities are public, the study protects privacy by concealing the names and any identifying details relevant to their content, particularly those

involving sensitive narratives. All transcriptions and digital files will be stored securely and accessed only by the researcher. In addition, the study complies with the Philippine Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173), which mandates the fair, lawful, and transparent processing of personal information, the principle of data minimization, and the implementation of organizational, physical, and technical safeguards to protect data from unauthorized access or disclosure. Guided by this policy, all information gathered will be used solely for academic purposes and handled with strict confidentiality.

2.5.4 Voluntary Participation

Since the study shall be analyzing secondary data, the creators voluntarily publish their episodes on Spotify (materials are publicly available), a formal consent or withdrawal process is rendered unnecessary for the current study. Nevertheless, the study respects their ownership of the content and avoids any analysis that may cause harm or misrepresent their perspective by any form of alteration in their content for analysis.

2.5.5 Minimization of Harm

The study follows a no-harm-reduction approach, presenting podcast content with accuracy, sensitivity, and respect. It avoids misinterpretation of emotional narratives or the misrepresentation of experiences by transcribing the materials and religiously translating it into English.

2.5.6 Beneficence

The study aims to contribute positively by deepening the understanding of Filipino LGBTQ discourse, identity formation, and community resilience. The researchers will have no direct contact with the content creators; hence, no form of remuneration or physical benefit will be afforded to the creators of the selected content.

2.5.7 Justice and Fair Participant Selection

Episodes are selected fairly based on relevance to Filipino LGBTQ experiences, ensuring diverse and balanced representation across different podcast channels. Episodes were fairly selected using purposive sampling indicated in the Research Environment, Population, and Sample.

2.5.8 Data Integrity and Accuracy

Raw transcripts with speakers talking in their native language and translations will undergo careful review to ensure accuracy and reliability. Likewise, oTranscribe will be use for the data transcription, and the other tools such as ATLAS.AI or MAXQDA for the data management. Lastly, results will always be manually checked to prevent errors.

2.5.9 Transparency in Reporting

The research findings will be reported truthfully, accurately, and transparently, ensuring that all interpretations remain grounded in the data collected from the selected podcast narratives. All copyrighted materials utilized, including publicly accessible podcast content, are properly cited and acknowledged in accordance with academic and ethical standards. No patented technologies were used in the conduct of this study.

2.5.10 Use of Copyrighted or Patented Materials

The study does not use patented tools or technologies. All podcast materials used are publicly accessible on Spotify, even on free accounts, and fall under fair use for academic purposes as specified by the Philippine policy on data privacy.

2.5.11 Ethical Considerations for Human and Animal Trials

The study does not involve human or animal testing. It solely analyzes already published and publicly accessible digital content.

2.5.12 Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies

Qualitative data analysis tools such as ATLAS.AI shall be used primarily for the generation of codes and themes for the analysis, ChatGPT, and Grammarly for assisting in correcting and enhancing the coherence of the study's grammar. Likewise, all AI-generated outputs are manually reviewed for accuracy, fidelity, and contextual correctness. The study avoids allowing AI to make interpretive judgments, as final coding and analysis rely on human expertise.

2.5.13 Ethical Approval

Although the study uses publicly available podcast content and undergo secondary data analysis, it will still still acquire approval from the Ethics Review Committee to ensure compliance with the institutional ethical requirements. This review ensures that the use of public digital media, AI-assisted tools, and discourse analysis practices adhere to established ethical standards.